A-A-696A
September 8, 1986
SUPERSEDING
A-A-696
September 17, 1982

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

TOWEL, PAPER

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to types I, II, and III of Federal Specification UU-T-591.

This description covers disposable, folded sheet paper towels intended for use in drying the hands.

Salient characteristics.

Towels shall be available in the following types, styles, and sizes:

Type I - Singlefold
Type II - Multifold
    Size 1
    Size 2
Type III - C-fold
    Style A - Light-to-medium embossed
    Style B - Heavy embossed

The towels shall conform to the requirements in table I. The issue of each TAPPI test method in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with the requirements.

Table I. Physical requirements

Characteristic	Requirement			TAPPI Test Method
	Types I and II	Type III		
		Style A	Style B	
Weight per unit area:				
Basis weight (24x36-500), pounds	25-30	25-30	25-30	T 410
Grammage, g/m^2	40.7-48.8	40.7-48.8	40.7-48.8	T 410
Water absorption, 0.1 ml, seconds (max.)	100	100	30	T 432
Tensile strength 1/, oz/in (N/m), avg. of both directions (min.)				
Dry	42 (458)	42 (458)	27 (294)	T 404 2/
Wet	12 (131)	12 (131)	8 (87)	T 456

1/ Before testing according to T 456, samples of towels shall be placed in a 105°C oven for 10-12 minutes and then conditioned according to T 402.

2/ T 494 may be used in lieu of T 404.

FSC 8540

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Towels of the type, size, and style specified shall conform to the dimension and area requirements in table II.

Table II. Sizes and areas

Type	Area (min.) (sq. in.)(cm^2)	Smaller dimension (inches)(cm)	Fold depth (inches)(cm)
I	99 (638.6)	9-1/4±1/2 (23.5±1.3)	5-1/2±1/2 (14.0±1.3)
II, Size 1	85 (548.3)	9-1/4±1/2 (23.5±1.3)	3-1/8±1/8 (8.0±0.3)
II, Size 2	130 (838.5)	9-1/4±1/2 (23.5±1.3)	2-5/8±1/8 (6.7±0.3)
III, Style A	130 (838.5)	10-1/8±1/2 (25.7±1.3)	4 ± 1/2 (10.2±1.3)
III, Style B	130 (838.5)	10-1/8±1/2 (25.7±1.3)	4 ± 1/2 (10.2±1.3)

Construction. Types I and II towels shall be interlocked to facilitate dispensing. Types I, II, and III towels shall fit and dispense satisfactorily from the dispensing cabinet having dimensions as specified in the invitation to bid.

Odor. Towels shall have no disagreeable odor when dry or wet. To test for odor when wet, soak one towel in distilled water at 73°F for 2 minutes. Then remove the towel from the water and smell it at a distance of 24 inches. Any disagreeable odor shall be grounds for rejection.

Surface finish and formation. Towels shall have a uniform formation and shall have a finish produced by creping or embossing. Towels having a gritty, sandpapery feel shall not be acceptable.

Workmanship. Towels shall be free of holes, tears, wrinkles, dirt, foreign material and other defects affecting appearance or serviceability. Edges shall be clean cut and not ragged.

Inspection of the end item. Sampling for examination and tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. For purposes of sampling, the lot size shall consist of towels of one type and size or style submitted for inspection at one time.

Examination for defects in dimensions and workmanship. The sample size shall be determined using level S-3, AQL 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one towel.

Testing. Use level S-1, AQL 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one package.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with the section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing supplier's employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. The preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

Note: TAPPI test methods are available from the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, Technology Park/Atlanta, P.O. Box 105113, Atlanta, GA 30348.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NOTE: DoD has determined that no military activity has an official interest in this commercial item description.

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

GSA-PBO
NASA-JFK
VA-OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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